BRENDEN BUSKIRK

AI Deployment Strategist · Solutions Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Ten years deploying technical systems into other companies' operations — machine vision, barcode and AutoID, precision measurement, and laser displacement systems installed at OptumRx, Johnson Controls, Keysight Technologies, Samtec, and Graham Packaging. Owns the full motion: technical discovery, solution design, on-site proof of concept against the customer's actual parts, and implementation. Three years building production Python systems through AI-assisted engineering workflows. Brings evidence discipline to AI claims: a self-built signal showing measurable directional lift over a random baseline returned approximately -10.9% modeled option return at a Kelly fraction of 0.00% under execution-aware modeling. It could predict without producing an economically useful decision, so it was retired.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Customer Discovery & Requirements Definition · Technical Workshops & Executive Presentations · Solution Design & Deployment · Proof of Concept Development · Technical Demonstrations · Technical Consulting · Capital Equipment Implementation · Python & REST API Integration · AI-Assisted Engineering Workflows (Claude Code) · LLM Prompting & Agentic Coding Workflows · Evaluation Design & Acceptance Criteria · Statistical Validation · Workflow & Process Mapping · Implementation Playbooks · Customer Training & Enablement · Enterprise Consultative Selling · Value Realization · Product Feedback Loops

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE — CUSTOMER-FACING TECHNICAL ROLES

Hughes Machinery, a Division of FCX Performance — Outside Sales Engineer **2024 – Apr 2026**

Nebraska & Western Iowa

- Owned discovery through commercial close on engineered boiler, valve, control, heat-transfer, and process-system projects for industrial and commercial facilities.
- Coordinated consulting engineers, mechanical contractors, manufacturers, and end users across requirements definition, system design, proposal, installation, and ongoing support — capital cycles where the technical evaluator, the economic buyer, and the installer were three different parties.

Victaulic — Territory Sales Representative **2022 – 2024**

Northern Colorado

- Sold at the specification level: presented to consulting engineers, challenged incumbent design approaches, and got piping methods written into project documents before bid — then carried mechanical contractors through submittal, coordination, and field installation.
- Built the business case on total installed cost, risk reduction, schedule compression, and installation labor rather than unit price; delivered apprentice and field training programs for contractor crews.
- Achieved 140% of annual sales goal in 2023 with over 200% unit growth, grew individual accounts by 500% and 1,000%, and closed a $500,000 fabrication package in late 2022.

Markem-Imaje — Account Manager **2021 – 2022**

Colorado & Utah

- Designed and sold turnkey coding, marking, and traceability systems for food, beverage, pharmaceutical, and industrial manufacturers.
- Led technical discovery across production-line workflow, line integration, uptime and reliability requirements, and regulatory traceability — partnering with service and engineering teams through implementation.

KEYENCE — Sales Engineer → Senior Sales Engineer **2016 – 2021**

Colorado, Utah, Montana, Idaho & Wyoming

- Deployed machine vision, barcode and AutoID, precision measurement, laser displacement, and static elimination systems into live production environments across a five-state territory.
- Delivered numerous documented capital-equipment deployments for recognizable enterprise manufacturers including OptumRx, Johnson Controls, Keysight Technologies, Samtec, Graham Packaging, KMG Chemicals, and Streck — each running

from technical discovery and on-site application testing through proof of concept, engineering collaboration, and implementation. Individual examples included five-figure technical projects.

- Proved inspection and measurement performance against the customer's actual parts and line conditions before purchase, working directly with end users, OEMs, and systems integrators.
- Achieved documented sales performance of 120% of cumulative goal across a measured three-month period while progressing from Sales Engineer to Senior Sales Engineer. Promoted twice; Salesperson of the Month, May 2021; 2019 Best Effort Award; mentored and trained incoming sales engineers.

INDEPENDENT AI & SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT

Self-Directed Technical Practice — System Architecture, Implementation & Validation **2023 – Present**

- Design and ship Python systems using AI coding agents (Claude Code) under a structured operating model: written briefs, acceptance criteria fixed before code is written, regression tests, structured self-review passes designed to falsify the result, and evidence-based release gates.
- Operate a multi-source real-time data platform on an unattended scheduled cycle — OAuth token and session management, failure sentinels, automated end-of-day processing, and a five-year historical corpus — hardened through repeated audit cycles that caught lookahead contamination, stale-price defects, and sign errors.
- Design the evaluation as deliberately as the system: random-baseline comparison, bootstrap confidence intervals, effect size (Cohen's d), and execution-aware economic modeling to separate a real effect from an artifact.

SELECTED TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Signal Validation & Real-Time Market Data Platform
Python · REST APIs · OAuth · Statistical Validation

- Built multi-source ingestion, normalization, real-time scanning, and scoring across three market-data providers, then built the layer that audited it: random-baseline comparison, bootstrap confidence intervals, Cohen's d, and execution-aware Black-Scholes modeling.
- The signal showed measurable directional lift over random, but modeled option return came back at approximately -10.9% with roughly a 10% win rate and a Kelly fraction of 0.00%. It was retired rather than deployed.

FR8 Boss — Freight Decision-Support Engine
Python · CLI Workflows · YAML Scenarios · Rules-Based Reasoning

- Decision-support workspace evaluating load economics against deadhead, timing, capacity, insurance, backhaul alternatives, and revenue per mile — converting unstructured inputs into explainable PASS / WARN / INTERVENE recommendations with written rationale and a reusable audit record.

Mulligan Made — Computer-Vision Swing Analysis
MediaPipe · OpenCV · Signal Processing · FFmpeg

- End-to-end video pipeline — phase detection, pose smoothing, biomechanics measurement — generating annotated replay video, overlays, heatmaps, and PDF summaries from upload with no manual steps.

TECHNOLOGY & METHODS

Python · REST APIs · Real-time data pipelines · OAuth and token/session management · Git · YAML · Claude Code and AI coding-agent workflows · LLM Prompting & Agentic Coding Workflows · Evaluation design and acceptance criteria · Random-baseline comparison · Bootstrap confidence intervals · Effect size (Cohen's d) · Execution-aware Black-Scholes modeling · MediaPipe · OpenCV · FFmpeg · Machine vision, AutoID and industrial automation · Requirements discovery · Solution architecture · Technical demonstration and POC design · Executive communication

EDUCATION

Wayne State College — B.S., Speech Communication **Wayne, NE**

Concentration: Organizational Leadership & Public Relations · NCAA football student-athlete